

1. Dear LaTeX,

It has been **eleven years**. Eleven years of `\begin{document}`, of mysterious vertical-mode errors, of citations rendered as `[?]` because BibTeX had Opinions about the .bib file I had not yet finished saving. Eleven years of you greeting every PDF I make with the same Computer Modern serif that everyone, everywhere, immediately recognises as *a sad student wrote this*.

I have moved on. The new arrangement embeds **real** TrueType outlines — Noto Sans, in this case — through a Type 0 CID font with a /ToUnicode CMap, which is a sentence I should not have to know, but here we are. Copy-paste round-trips. Search works. The Polish co-author gets **Łódź** instead of *L*, a space, and an apostrophe. The Czech reviewer gets **Příliš žluťoučký kůň** without three preamble lines of `\usepackage{}` ritual. The Russian correspondents get **Привет, Мозаика**. The Greek desk gets **Καλημέρα, κόσμε**. None of them get an email from me asking which encoding their text editor was using when they sent the draft.

The math, fine, you were good at math. I will give you that. But I am also done feeling like a fraud for pasting a single $\leq$ into a paragraph and being forced to load `amsmath`, `amssymb`, and a third package whose name I have forgotten because the universe took it from me. Mosaic shapes math operators ($\leq \geq \neq \sqrt{\partial \Sigma}$) through automatic per-glyph fallback to the bundled Noto Sans Math cut — mid-word, mid-sentence, no `#set text(font: ...)`, no `\usepackage{}`, no `$ ... $`. The body face does not contain them; the fallback face does; the layout engine notices on its own and routes the cluster. The result reads like prose because it *is* prose: $\partial f / \partial x \neq 0$ sits in this line the same way "the" does.

My grievances, in no particular order except the one I wrote them in:

1. The error messages. **Especially** the one about `\par`.
2. The figure handling. One `#figure(image: "...", caption: "...")` block here, and forty minutes of `\begin{figure}[!htbp]` float-placement bargaining there. I have aged out of caring which letters do which.
3. The fi/fl ligatures, which you handled but never let me actually see without diagnostic incantations. Mine ship as one glyph in the PDF the way the typographer intended — copy "figment" or "flicker" out of this document and paste it somewhere; the ligature collapses back into the source codepoints on the way out. It is shaping, not a font hack.

Sub-grievances, indented because that is also a thing now:

- The way you treated quotation marks. We have em dashes — like that — without three hyphens, and no, I will not be installing a package for it.
- The way `verbatim` and `code` could never quite agree about whitespace.
- Yes, I know it was the package's fault.
- I do not care whose fault it was.
- The bibliography. I am still angry about the bibliography.

1.1. Some good news

Italic still means italic. **Bold** still means bold. They route through the real designed cuts of Noto Sans, not a faux- slant transformation, and the same is true in Cyrillic (*күрсүө* , **жирный**) and Greek (*πλάγια* , **έντονα**). If anyone needs the Adobe Core 14 fonts (you, mostly, when you are nostalgic), `#set text(font: "Helvetica")` is still there. It will look exactly like the 1985 you remember.

I am attaching a screenshot of what the README promised, so we can compare it later with what shipped. You will notice it does not say `\documentclass{article}` anywhere.



Exhibit A. A PNG, appearing here, below the sentence that references it, as God intended and LaTeX refused.

Yours, with twenty-three open browser tabs of Stack Exchange threads from 2007,
Mosaic